

TCD Template

Day 1 handout. The 6-section Technical Concept Document (TCD) skeleton your quad builds across Week 4 — the sibling artifact to your Week-3 PRD. Print it, pin it, fill it section by section. Each section carries a [Day X] tag telling you when it gets written. Friday it ships, peer-reviewed and signed off.

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# Technical Concept Document – <feature name>
**Sibling to:** PRD <link> | **Authors:** <quad>
| **Status:** Draft / Reviewed

## 1. Architecture stance
[Day 1]
Monolith / microservice / hybrid. One paragraph
defending the call from
business + operational angles (deploy cadence,
failure domain, scaling axis) –
not framework hype.

## 2. Integration map
[Day 1 + Day 3]
Which existing systems / services this feature
depends on, calls, or extends.
Drafted Day 1 as the 5-column table (system / owner
/ sync-async / R-W /
failure handling); references the C4 Container
diagram drawn on Day 3.

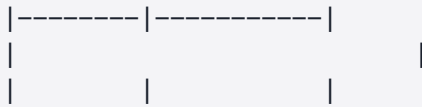
## 3. Security & compliance constraints
[Day 2]
STRIDE pass summary – the 3–5 highest-priority
threats and their concrete
mitigations. Updated security and compliance NFRs
(replaces the Week-3 first
draft). Name which compliance frame applies (SOC 2 /
privacy / industry).

## 4. SLO + rate-limit policy
[Day 4]
– Latency: p50 / p95 / p99 targets, each with a one-
line defense
– Availability: monthly target + error budget
– Rate limits: per-user / per-tenant / global, and
what each protects

## 5. Top 5 trade-offs
[Day 5]
Each trade-off names: Option A, Option B, the call
we made, the cost we accept,
and the trigger that would cause us to revisit. Span
at least 3 categories.

## 6. Stakeholders + sign-off matrix
[Day 5]
| Constraint (TCD section) | Stakeholder (a person)
| Status | Next step |
|-----|-----

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Status vocabulary: Proposed / Discussed / Approved / Blocked.

How the sections build on each other

- **§1 stance** sets the shape everything else documents. A modular-monolith stance shows in §2 as one container with internal modules.
- **§2 integrations** are the boundaries §3 threat-models — every integration either appears in the threat model or has an explicit "no threat" rationale.
- **§3 security NFRs** must not silently conflict with **§4 SLOs**; if they do, that tension is a **§5 trade-off**.
- **§5 trade-offs** and **§6 owners** are what a senior architect interrogates first — every load-bearing decision has an owner in §6.

Friday review rubric (score 0–4 per dimension)

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Stance defensibility	20%	Architecture call defended in business terms; framework hype absent
Threat-model rigor	20%	3–5 named threats with concrete mitigations; not boilerplate
Component clarity	15%	C4 diagram readable; external dependencies named
SLO realism	20%	Targets anchored to user behavior; error budget the team will actually keep
Trade-off honesty	15%	Both sides named; trigger to revisit specified
Stakeholder map	10%	Each constraint has an owner; sign-off status is honest

The bar: a one- to two-page TCD an architect or engineering lead would accept as scoping input. The TCD ships alongside the PRD into Week 5.